

Figurative Language

Grade 4 Reading Comprehension Worksheet

Read each sentence. Choose the meaning of the quoted phrase.

1. The baby's laugh was music to our ears.

What does 'music to our ears' mean?

- a. Our ears hurt from the noise.
- b. It was a wonderful sound to hear.
- c. The baby was singing a song.

2. My brother eats like a horse.

What does 'eats like a horse' mean?

- a. He eats very slowly.
- b. He eats a huge amount of food.
- c. He eats hay and oats.

3. The classroom was a zoo this morning.

What does 'the classroom was a zoo' mean?

- a. Animals visited the class.
- b. It was wild and noisy.
- c. It was quiet and calm.

4. She is as busy as a bee.

What does 'as busy as a bee' mean?

- a. She makes honey.
- b. She works very hard all day.
- c. She buzzes when she talks.

5. The test was a piece of cake.

What does 'a piece of cake' mean?

- a. It was about baking.
- b. It was very easy.
- c. It was sweet.

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Read each sentence. Choose the meaning of the quoted phrase.

1. He ran as fast as lightning.

What does 'as fast as lightning' mean?

- a. He was scared of storms.
- b. He ran in the rain.
- c. He ran extremely fast.

2. Her smile was sunshine on a cloudy day.

What does 'her smile was sunshine' mean?

- a. The sun came out.
- b. Her smile made everyone feel happy.
- c. She was standing outside.

3. The old car coughed and sputtered like a sick dog.

What does 'like a sick dog' mean?

- a. It made weak, rough noises.
- b. The car needed a vet.
- c. A dog was in the car.

4. Time flies when we are having fun.

What does 'time flies' mean?

- a. Time seems to pass quickly.
- b. We are late.
- c. Clocks can fly.

5. He has a heart of gold.

What does 'a heart of gold' mean?

- a. He is very kind.
- b. He is rich.
- c. His heart is made of metal.

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Read each sentence. Choose the meaning of the quoted phrase.

1. The snow was a white blanket over the town.

What does 'a white blanket' mean here?

- a. Snow covered everything softly.
- b. Everyone was sleeping.
- c. The town was cold.

2. She sings like an angel.

What does 'sings like an angel' mean?

- a. She has wings.
- b. Her voice is beautiful.
- c. She sings in church.

3. The playground was as loud as a drum.

What does 'as loud as a drum' mean?

- a. Someone played a drum.
- b. It was musical.
- c. It was extremely noisy.

4. His backpack was as heavy as a rock.

What does 'as heavy as a rock' mean?

- a. It was very heavy.
- b. It was hard.
- c. It was full of rocks.

5. The baby slept like a log.

What does 'slept like a log' mean?

- a. She slept on wood.
- b. She snored loudly.
- c. She slept very deeply.

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Read each sentence. Choose the meaning of the quoted phrase.

1. Her cheeks were as red as apples.

What does 'as red as apples' mean?

- a. She was a clown.
- b. Her cheeks were very red.
- c. She was eating apples.

2. The wind howled like a wolf all night.

What does 'like a wolf' mean here?

- a. The night was scary.
- b. The wind made a loud howling sound.
- c. A wolf was outside.

3. He was as brave as a lion.

What does 'as brave as a lion' mean?

- a. He was very courageous.
- b. He had a mane.
- c. He lived in Africa.

4. The stars were diamonds in the sky.

What does 'stars were diamonds' mean?

- a. The stars sparkled brightly.
- b. Diamonds fell from the sky.
- c. The sky was expensive.

5. She swims like a fish.

What does 'swims like a fish' mean?

- a. She is an excellent swimmer.
- b. She has fins.
- c. She breathes underwater.

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Read each sentence. Choose the meaning of the quoted phrase.

1. The kitchen is the heart of our home.

What does 'the heart of our home' mean?

- a. It is the biggest room.
- b. It is the warm center where everyone gathers.
- c. It pumps blood.

2. He was shaking like a leaf.

What does 'shaking like a leaf' mean?

- a. He was trembling a lot.
- b. He fell from a tree.
- c. He was green.

3. The new bike was as shiny as a new penny.

What does 'as shiny as a new penny' mean?

- a. It was made of copper.
- b. It cost one cent.
- c. It gleamed brightly.

4. Her voice was as smooth as honey.

What does 'as smooth as honey' mean?

- a. She was eating honey.
- b. Her voice was sticky.
- c. Her voice was sweet and pleasant.

5. The mountain stood like a giant guarding the valley.

What does 'like a giant guarding the valley' mean?

- a. The mountain looked big and protective.
- b. A giant lived there.
- c. The valley was in danger.

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Read each sentence. Choose the meaning of the quoted phrase.

1. Ideas were popping like popcorn in his head.

What does 'like popcorn' mean here?

- a. His head hurt.
- b. He was hungry.
- c. Ideas came fast, one after another.

2. The fog was a gray curtain over the city.

What does 'a gray curtain' mean here?

- a. The city had curtains.
- b. It was going to rain.
- c. Fog covered the city like a curtain.

3. She was as light as a feather on the stage.

What does 'as light as a feather' mean?

- a. She was very small.
- b. She wore feathers.
- c. She moved gracefully and easily.

4. His temper was a volcano ready to erupt.

What does 'his temper was a volcano' mean?

- a. He liked volcanoes.
- b. His anger was about to explode.
- c. He was hot.

5. The river danced over the rocks.

What does 'the river danced' mean?

- a. The water moved quickly and playfully.
- b. Fish were dancing.
- c. The river was at a party.

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Read each sentence. Choose the meaning of the quoted phrase.

1. She has eyes like a hawk.

What does 'eyes like a hawk' mean?

- a. She sees very small details.
- b. Her eyes are yellow.
- c. She can fly.

2. The old house groaned in the wind.

What does 'the house groaned' mean?

- a. The house was sad.
- b. It made creaking noises in the wind.
- c. Someone was inside.

3. He is as stubborn as a mule.

What does 'as stubborn as a mule' mean?

- a. He has long ears.
- b. He works on a farm.
- c. He refuses to change his mind.

4. The clouds were cotton balls in the sky.

What does 'clouds were cotton balls' mean?

- a. Cotton was falling.
- b. It was snowing.
- c. The clouds were soft, white, and puffy.

5. Her laugh was like music.

What does 'like music' mean here?

- a. She was singing.
- b. She played an instrument.
- c. Her laugh was pleasant to hear.

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Read each sentence. Choose the meaning of the quoted phrase.

1. The car was as slow as a snail.

What does 'as slow as a snail' mean?

- a. The car was small.
- b. A snail was driving.
- c. The car moved very slowly.

2. His words were ice.

What does 'his words were ice' mean?

- a. He was eating ice.
- b. The room was cold.
- c. His words felt cold and unkind.

3. She was as happy as a clam.

What does 'as happy as a clam' mean?

- a. She lived underwater.
- b. She had a shell.
- c. She was very content.

4. The thunder growled like an angry beast.

What does 'like an angry beast' mean?

- a. The thunder was loud and scary.
- b. A beast was outside.
- c. The storm was alive.

5. The field was a sea of yellow flowers.

What does 'a sea of yellow flowers' mean?

- a. There were countless yellow flowers.
- b. The flowers were wet.
- c. The field was flooded.

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Read each sentence. Choose the meaning of the quoted phrase.

1. He swam as fast as a dolphin.

What does 'as fast as a dolphin' mean?

- a. He held his breath.
- b. He lived in the sea.
- c. He swam extremely fast.

2. Her hair was silk in the sunlight.

What does 'her hair was silk' mean?

- a. Her hair was expensive.
- b. Her hair was smooth and shiny.
- c. She wore a silk scarf.

3. The night was as black as coal.

What does 'as black as coal' mean?

- a. The night was completely dark.
- b. There was a fire.
- c. Coal was burning.

4. He eats like a bird.

What does 'eats like a bird' mean?

- a. He eats only tiny amounts.
- b. He eats worms.
- c. He has a beak.

5. The tree's branches were arms reaching for the sky.

What does 'branches were arms' mean?

- a. The tree was alive.
- b. The branches stretched upward like arms.
- c. Someone was climbing.

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Read each sentence. Choose the meaning of the quoted phrase.

1. She was as quiet as a mouse.

What does 'as quiet as a mouse' mean?

- a. She was small.
- b. She liked cheese.
- c. She made almost no sound.

2. The sun was a golden coin in the sky.

What does 'a golden coin' mean here?

- a. The day was expensive.
- b. Money fell from the sky.
- c. The sun looked round and bright gold.

3. His room was a pigsty.

What does 'his room was a pigsty' mean?

- a. His room smelled.
- b. His room was very messy.
- c. A pig lived there.

4. She runs like the wind.

What does 'runs like the wind' mean?

- a. She makes noise.
- b. She is invisible.
- c. She runs extremely fast.

5. The baby's cheeks were rosy apples.

What does 'cheeks were rosy apples' mean?

- a. Her cheeks were round and red.
- b. She was a doll.
- c. She was eating apples.